

Memorandum of Understanding (MOU)

Between 50501 Inc. and Verified Chapters Regarding Trademark Usage and Organizational Affiliation

This Memorandum of Understanding (“MOU”) is entered into by and between 50501 Inc., a nonprofit corporation duly formed under the laws of the Commonwealth of Virginia and registered as a foreign nonprofit entity in Washington, D.C. (hereinafter referred to as “the Corporation”), and the undersigned verified chapter of the 50501 movement (hereinafter referred to as “the Chapter”).

This agreement is made in recognition of the need to establish clear expectations for the authorized use of federally registered trademarks, the protection of the 50501 brand, and the alignment of chapter-level organizing with the foundational mission and values of 50501 Inc.

I. Purpose

This MOU exists to:

1. Formally authorize the Chapter’s use of protected 50501 branding and intellectual property;
2. Establish non-negotiable standards of conduct and alignment with the values of 50501 Inc.;
3. Prevent unauthorized, unethical, or commercial misuse of the Corporation’s identity;
4. Provide a clear framework for brand integrity, accountability, and mutual trust;
5. Define conditions under which the Chapter’s verification and usage rights may be revoked.

II. Trademark Identification

The following trademarks are the exclusive legal property of 50501 Inc. and are protected under federal law:

1. “50501” — USPTO Serial No. 99122369
2. “50 Protests. 50 States. 1 Movement.” — USPTO Serial No. 99122956
3. “50 States. 50 Protests. 1 Day.” — USPTO Serial No. 99145912

These marks are federally registered under International Classes 35 and 41, which cover nonprofit advocacy, mutual aid, community organizing, political education, public demonstrations, and digital/educational media production.

III. Grant of Trademark Usage Rights

Upon execution of this MOU and confirmation of active verification, the Chapter is hereby granted:

- **A non-exclusive, non-commercial, non-transferrable, and revocable license** to use the above trademarks in alignment with the mission and public image of 50501 Inc.
- Permission to use the “50501” name and associated slogans in:
 - Social media branding
 - Community outreach
 - Educational or organizing materials
 - Protest signage and mutual aid efforts
 - Print and digital communications

All use must include a clear reference to the chapter’s regional identity (e.g., “50501 Vermont,” “50501 Bay Area,” “50501 Youth”).

IV. Chapter Responsibilities

By signing this MOU, the Chapter affirms its commitment to:

1. Uphold all 10 principles outlined in The 50501 Principles of Purpose and Integrity, including but not limited to non-violence, inclusion, non-partisanship, and solidarity with the oppressed.
2. Never use the 50501 brand for commercial gain, self-promotion, political endorsements, or partnerships without prior approval.
3. Maintain alignment with the Corporation’s values in all public organizing, representation, and messaging.
4. Respect autonomy while maintaining brand consistency, using official design assets and naming conventions as provided.
5. Keep internal governance democratic and accessible, with zero tolerance for discrimination, harassment, or gatekeeping.
6. Designate at least one point of contact to receive national communications, legal notices, or updates regarding branding, trademark policy, and chapter standing.
7. Notify the Corporation within 10 days if leadership changes, public controversy arises, or organizational activity ceases.

V. Prohibited Uses and Restrictions

The Chapter **may not**:

- Modify the logos or slogans in ways that misrepresent the brand;
- Claim ownership or exclusivity over any version of the 50501 name;
- Use the trademarks to support or oppose political candidates;
- Enter sponsorship, licensing, or commercial agreements using the 50501 name;

- Create new state or identity-based 50501 offshoots without written authorization;
- Use the brand for financial transactions not disclosed to the Corporation.

Any violation of the above shall be considered a **breach of this agreement**.

VI. Revocation of Trademark Access and Chapter Status

50501 Inc. reserves the right to **immediately revoke** the Chapter's trademark usage and verification status if:

1. The Chapter violates any provision of this agreement;
2. The Chapter engages in conduct that materially damages the public reputation or legal standing of 50501 Inc.;
3. The Chapter uses the brand for personal, political, or commercial gain;
4. The Chapter is found to be inactive, misleading the public, or misrepresenting affiliation;
5. The Chapter fails to respond to three (3) official communications from the Corporation.

Upon revocation, the Chapter must:

- Cease use of the 50501 name, logos, and slogans;
- Take down all public profiles or platforms branded under 50501;
- Return or destroy any protected branding or templates;
- Remove affiliation language from digital assets within fourteen (14) days.

VII. Legal Protections and Enforcement

- This MOU is governed by the laws of the **Commonwealth of Virginia**, and all disputes shall be resolved in a court of competent jurisdiction in that state.
- The Corporation may pursue legal action, including injunctive relief, if this agreement is violated or if the trademarks are unlawfully used.
- Chapters agree that the Corporation retains full legal ownership and final authority over branding, and that the Corporation's decision to revoke affiliation is **non-negotiable and final**.

VIII. Term and Renewal

This MOU shall remain in effect for **twelve (12) months** from the date of execution. At the end of the term, the Chapter may renew its verification and trademark license by completing an updated form and confirming active alignment with the 50501 values and operational criteria.

Failure to renew will result in automatic expiration of chapter status and trademark usage rights.

IX. Entire Agreement

This MOU constitutes the **entire understanding** between the Corporation and the Chapter with respect to trademark usage, chapter affiliation, and all related matters addressed herein.

It supersedes all prior or contemporaneous communications, proposals, negotiations, or understandings, whether oral or written.

No other agreements, representations, or conditions shall be valid unless made in writing and signed by both parties.

X. Dispute Resolution

In the event of a disagreement arising from the interpretation, enforcement, or performance of this MOU, the parties agree to attempt **informal resolution in good faith**.

If resolution cannot be achieved within thirty (30) days, either party may pursue legal remedies, subject to the jurisdiction provisions outlined in Section VII.

This clause shall not prevent the Corporation from seeking **immediate injunctive relief** to protect its trademarks, public integrity, or prevent ongoing harm.

XI. Electronic Signatures and Execution

This agreement may be executed in **electronic or digital form**, including through the use of e-signature tools, scanned signatures, or other verifiable digital means.

Such signatures shall be deemed legally binding and admissible in court to the same extent as a physical handwritten signature.

Copies, whether electronic or printed, shall be considered originals for all legal and enforcement purposes.

XII. Acknowledgment and Agreement

By signing below, the Chapter affirms that it understands and agrees to the terms of this MOU. The Chapter recognizes that trademark usage is a privilege—**not a right**—and agrees to act in full compliance with this agreement, in good faith, and in collective solidarity with the mission of 50501 Inc.

IN WITNESS WHEREOF, the parties hereby execute this Memorandum of Understanding as of the date signed below:

Chapter Name: _____

Designated Representative: _____

Signature: _____

Date: _____

50501 Inc. – National Chapter Coordination Team

Authorized Signatory: _____

Title: _____

Date: _____